

week 7 lecture notes

How to Write a paper

Here we will explore how to write a research paper in the sciences. This is not meant to be comprehensive, as such you should only use it as a *tips and tricks* article. It is a gross over simplification (so I thought for so long) to address a paper in terms of introduction, body, and conclusion. Naturally this is how I will make the split here.

Introduction

An introduction serves as both a *hook* and a kind of *summary*. With the introduction you should create interest in the reader or at least attempt to. This can be done by presenting some more *flashy* peices of your research. This is where you will state your purpose for the research and your thesis. This does not have to complicated, that said it can take a touch of inspiration for those to whom it is new.

Body

The body is all the little details of your research. Here you outline with structure and utilize the larger space to go into massive detail. Break your body up into *subsections*. This practice will allow you to create purpose built paragraphs.

Conclusion

This can be described as another introduction. Summarize your papers contents into something brief section as compared to your body. Restate your hypothesis (thesis) and your *flashy* facts to end the paper. In a purposeful investigation you will also state your results here.

A saying I like to give when explaining how to write a paper is “tell me what you are going to tell me (intro), tell me (body), tell me what you told me (conclusion)”.

Errors

In most modern programming languages the idea of *error handling* has become quite common. The idea is that if you break the rules of the logic in the programming language it is not only detected but usable. This is to say that the system allows the programmer to manually handle the error instead of crashing. In Python this is beyond your skill level, however it error handling is very useful in many situations.